

# Who Does What: Parent and Student

FILL IN TOGETHER

Writes down who owns each task, so the process is a partnership rather than a parent doing it all or a 17-year-old left alone with it. Sign it. It settles arguments before they start.

When: The start of junior year, revisited each term

## Mark each task S (student), P (parent) or B (both)

|                                         | S / P / B | By when |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------|---------|
| Researching colleges                    |           |         |
| Booking campus visits                   |           |         |
| Keeping the deadline calendar           |           |         |
| Writing the essays                      |           |         |
| Proofreading the essays                 |           |         |
| Asking teachers for recommendations     |           |         |
| Requesting transcripts                  |           |         |
| Registering for the SAT/ACT             |           |         |
| Filling in the FAFSA                    |           |         |
| Gathering tax documents                 |           |         |
| Talking to financial aid offices        |           |         |
| Searching and applying for scholarships |           |         |
| Opening and reading college emails      |           |         |
| Replying to colleges                    |           |         |
| Making the final decision               |           |         |

## Ground rules we agree on

How often we talk about college (and when we do not)

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What the student handles alone, even if it is done imperfectly

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What the parent handles because it is genuinely theirs

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What we do when one of us is stressed about it

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**Signed**

Student

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Parent

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Date

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**WORTH KNOWING**

- ◆ The student should own the essays and the emails. Colleges notice when a parent writes.
- ◆ Money tasks are the parent's. Do not hand a teenager the tax return.
- ◆ Agreeing when NOT to discuss college is as useful as agreeing when to.